Honey Norfolk

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PERSONAL STATEMENT

I am pursuing two Bachelor of Science degrees, one in Robotics Engineering, the other in Sociology, with a minor in Economics. My studies center on Robotics, Artificial Intelligence, and Human-Robot Social Interaction, with a strong interest in the social and ethical implications of these technologies. Alongside my research focus, I have developed a growing interest in policy and how it shapes the responsible development and governance of emerging technologies.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's of Science in Robotics Engineering
University of Central Arkansas | Expected Graduation Spring 2027 | 3.118 GPA

Bachelor's of Science in Sociology, Minor in Economics
University of Central Arkansas | Expected Graduation Spring 2027 | 3.118 GPA

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

12/2025-Present
Undergraduate Research: Human-Robot Interaction *Research Assistant* **Conway, Arkansas**

- Brought the SAMI social robot to campus through a partnership with Oregon State University and integrated it into Human-Robot Interaction research, prompting the formation of a faculty-led HRI lab.
- Designed study examining how students' expectations of a robot's appearance differ from actual physical form, and whether brief interactions shift expectations.
- Secured $30,000 grant from the Arkansas Space Grant Consortium (ASGC) to support the project.

06/2025-8/2025
Oregon State University REU: Robots in the Real World *Researcher* **Corvallis, Oregon**
Advisor: Dr. Bill Smart
"Push It (Real Good): Examining Human Choices to Engage Robots in Group Interaction."

- Programmed Quori robot interaction system to listen and respond to participants, integrating speech recognition, text-to-speech, and conversational styles (empathetic, logical, irritated)
- Designed and conducted study investigating how likely humans are to involve a robot in group conversation and how its behavior shapes participation.
- Collected and analyzed participant survey and interaction data to determine whether people include Quori, their reasons for doing so or not, and how conversational style influences likelihood of inclusion.

05/2025-06/2026
Undergraduate Research: Artificial Influence *Research Assistant* **Conway, Arkansas**
Advisor: Dr Patrick Casey

- Researched the AI alignment problem, focusing on how AI might affect human values and decision-making.
- Studied existing work on how AI can be used to affect social influence and decision-making.
- Contributed insights to ongoing discussions on AI ethics and unintended outcomes of AI use.

08/2024-Present
Honors in the Major Thesis | UCA Department of Sociology, Criminology, and Anthropology **Conway, Arkansas**
Advisor: Dr. Stacy Lom
"The Machine Didn't Cheat: Students, Faculty, and the Human Problem"

- Explored how AI culture shapes teaching, engagement, and course design using qualitative research methods.
- Completed honors thesis, culminating in a formal written manuscript and public oral defense. (*Currently writing paper for submission to academic journal.)*

01/2024-10/2026
Undergraduate Research: AI-Generated Text Analysis *Researcher* **Conway, Arkansas**
Advisor: Dr. Patrick Casey
"'AI can't write like that!': A Test of People's Ability to Differentiate Between Human and AI-Generated Text"

- Investigated how individuals distinguish human-written from AI-generated text across writing styles and formats.
- Designed and administered surveys to investigate how participants identify human-written versus AI-generated text, evaluate authorship cues across writing styles, and apply prior knowledge perceptions when judging text authenticity.

Student Highlight, Arkansas Democrat-Gazette

Highlight demonstrating my presentation of this research at the Arkansas State Capitol in a STEM research showcase.

01/2024-08/2025

Psychology of Existence (POE) Lab *Research Assistant* **Conway, Arkansas**

- Researching on cognitive and cross-cultural predictors of moral judgments regarding existential risks, including risks from artificial intelligence.
- Design, conduct, and analyze data from psychological studies, focusing on existential and cognitive psychology.
- Collaborating with interdisciplinary teams to refine experimental methods and ensure ethical compliance.

Summer, 06/2023-08/2025

Undergraduate Research: Eclipse Endeavor *Research Assistant* **Conway, Arkansas**

- Led a research project focused on enhancing science education in schools across multiple Arkansas cities
- Managed teacher training workshops to empower educators with the knowledge and skills to effectively use data loggers, along with developing student engagement and scientific curiosity.
- Implemented data loggers in schools to enable real-time data collection and analysis in various science disciplines, improving the learning experience for Arkansas students and educators.

UCA Collects State Eclipse Data

Article describing my responsibilities in the eclipse project both in soldering and education, advised by Dr. William Slaton.

WORK EXPERIENCE

08/2026-Present

Arkansas Department of Education *Computer Science Intern*

Division of Career and Technical Education (CTE) **Little Rock, Arkansas**

- Develop and deliver a presentation on AI ethics and responsible AI use for educators and stakeholders.
- Attend and support computer science professional development sessions and CS Impact meetings.
- Advise on educational resources and provide feedback on content, accessibility, and instructional effectiveness.

06/2026-Present

Campaign Associate *Governor Campaign*

Fredrick Love for Governor (Democratic Nominee) **Little Rock, Arkansas**

- Engage with constituents during campaign events and community visits across Arkansas.
- Assist with community outreach by listening to voter concerns and communicating campaign priorities.
- Participate in discussions of campaign policy proposals and research issues affecting Arkansas communities.

06/2026-08/2026

Arkansas Department of Education *Public Service Intern*

Division of Career and Technical Education (CTE) **Little Rock, Arkansas**

- Traveled to multiple locations across Arkansas to deliver professional development workshops for educators on Python, computer science, artificial intelligence, and related technology topics.
- Co-developed educational resources and AI training materials, including teacher videos covering AI fundamentals, classroom applications, responsible use, and academic integrity.
- Researched Arkansas workforce needs, mapped career pathways to SOC codes, and identified occupational skills and instructional strategies to improve career and technical education.

03/2025-Present

Arkansas State Senate *Cabinet Member, Arkansas Higher Education Subcommittee* **Little Rock, Arkansas**

- Selected by the Subcommittee Chair to serve in an advisory capacity supporting the Arkansas Legislative Council's Higher Education Subcommittee
- Contribute to discussions on higher education policy and the integration of AI within Arkansas's education system, with focus on its social and ethical implications, impact on education, and transparency.

06/17/2024-06/21/2024, 06/16/2025-06/20/2025, 06/2026-6/5/2026

UCA AI Robotics & Ethics Camp 2024/2025 *Facilitator* **Conway, Arkansas**

- Led problem-solving sessions applying ethical frameworks to real-world AI scenarios.
- Assisted participants in troubleshooting robotics projects, teaching problem-solving in robotics engineering.
- Supported inclusive dialogue and diverse perspectives in AI ethics discussions.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

1/2026-Present

AI and Society *Teaching Assistant* **Conway, Arkansas**

- Assisted in course instruction, including preparing lecture materials and supporting in-class discussions on AI ethics, policy, and societal impact.
- Offered individualized guidance to students on assignments and research methodology.

AI and Society Curriculum Presentation, an outline used as the class curriculum.

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE & ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

10/2026-Present

TechTonic Justice *Intern* **Little Rock, Arkansas**

- Led 10 public education workshops reaching 200+ community members affected by automated decisions, helping them understand their rights and how automated systems can affect access to public benefits.
- Contributed research and data synthesis for policy briefs evaluating community impacts of automated decision-making systems in Arkansas
- Partnered with TechTonic Justice to launch a year-long community AI literacy initiative, which led to an offer to join the organization as an intern.

09/2026-Present

Arkansas Collegiate Civic Leadership Academy (ACCLA) *Cohort Member 2027* **Morrilton, Arkansas**

- Selected as one of 25 students statewide to complete an intensive civic leadership and public policy program hosted by the Winthrop Rockefeller Institute.
- Initiated a year-long community service project in partnership with TechTonic Justice, a local nonprofit, to expand community access to AI literacy, technology education, and responsible technology use.

08/2025-08/2026

College of Science and Engineering Mentor *Mentor* **Conway, Arkansas**

- Provide one-on-one guidance to first-year science and engineering students on course planning, study methods, and campus resources.

9/2025-08/26

Student Government Association (SGA) *Representative, College of Science and Engineering* **Conway, Arkansas**

- Initiated development of an AI & Academic Integrity training module with Vector Solutions to promote ethical use.
- Collaborated with faculty and administrators to create a clear, student-centered AI policy for academic consistency.

9/2024-8/2026

IEEE Student Chapter *Founder | President* **Conway, Arkansas**

- Established the first IEEE student chapter at UCA, recruiting 15+ founding members.
- Led chapter activities, promoted student-industry collaboration, and oversaw fundraising, membership, and planning.
- Chartered a local Link of the Order of the Engineer to give UCA students the opportunity to participate in the Ring Ceremony and uphold the engineering profession's ethical commitment.

08/2024-08/2026

Ethics Bowl *Member* **Conway, Arkansas**

- Researched ethical issues, constructed well-supported arguments, and applied philosophical principles to real-world cases through team debates and competitive ethical reasoning.

03/2023-08/2026

Minority Mentorship Program *Mentor | Co-Director* **Conway, Arkansas**

- Co-directed the executive team to advance strategic initiatives and coordinate operations while mentoring underrepresented students to support their academic success and personal growth.

10/2022-Present

College of Science and Engineering Ambassador *Member* **Conway, Arkansas**

- Represent the College of Science and Engineering to prospective students through campus tours, recruitment activities, and engagement with visitors, students, and faculty at university events.

08/2022-08/2026

Robotics Club *Social Media Manager | Vice-President | President* **Conway, Arkansas**

- Led and coordinated club activities, weekly meetings, workshops, and project planning sessions for 20+ members.
- Collaborated with team members to design, build, and program robots for competitions.
- Managed social media platforms to promote club activities, increase engagement, and attract new members.

AWARDS AND HONORS

Honors in the Major – Sociology — 2024-*Present*

University of Central Arkansas, Department of Sociology, Criminology, and Anthropology

Selected to complete an intensive thesis-based distinction within major field

Outstanding Community Outreach by a Student Organization, Robotics Club — 2025

Award presented to recognized student organization that has shown a commitment to providing service and outreach to UCA and the local community.

AURS STEM Communicator Award 2nd Place — 2025

The AURS STEM Communicator Award is awarded for excellence in public science communication for delivering a 3-Minute Thesis, designed to communicate complex research to the public in an informative and compelling manner. I received this award for my presentation, "AI Can't Write Like That."

Shepherd Award for Outstanding Undergraduate Research Performance — 2025

Department of Sociology, Criminology, and Anthropology, University of Central Arkansas, Fall 2025

Selected by departmental faculty for the quality of my undergraduate research, my involvement in ongoing research projects, and my contributions to the department's community. Recipients are listed on department's permanent award plaque, receive graduation medal, and gain eligibility for additional research funding through the Shepherd Fund. Award winners are also nominated for the College of Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences Outstanding Student Award.

Purple Society (Who's Who Among UCA Students) — 2026

University of Central Arkansas - Inducted: 2026

The Purple Society continues the national Who's Who Among Students in American Universities and Colleges tradition at UCA. The program recognizes students nominated for strong academic performance, campus leadership, and service. UCA created the Purple Society in 2018, when the national program went on hiatus.

PUBLICATIONS

Honey, Norfolk. *"'AI can't write like that!': A Test of People's Ability to Differentiate Between Human and AI-Generated Text,"* Journal of Undergraduate Research in Anthropology (JURA). *Accepted for publication, June 2026.*

POSTER PRESENTATIONS

Norfolk, Honey. "Push It (Real Good): Examining Human Choices to Engage Robots in Group Interaction."*IEEE Arkansas Section Meeting*, University of Central Arkansas, Conway, AR, September 27, 2025.

Norfolk, Honey. "'AI can't write like that!': A Test of People's Ability to Differentiate Between AI and Human-Generated Text." *2025 COSE Annual Student Research Symposium,* University of Central Arkansas, Conway, AR, April 18, 2025.

Norfolk, Honey. "'AI can't write like that!': A Test of People's Ability to Differentiate Between AI and Human-Generated Text." *2025 STEM Posters at the Capitol*, Arkansas State Capitol, Little Rock, AR, January 30, 2025.

ORAL PRESENTATIONS

Norfolk, Honey. "The Machine Didn't Cheat: Students, Faculty, and the Human Problem" *Arkansas Association of Sociology, Anthropology, and Criminology (AASAC)*, University of Central Arkansas, Conway, AR, October 31st, 2025.

Norfolk, Honey. "Push It (Real Good): Examining Human Choices to Engage Robots in Group Interaction." *Robots in the Real World REU*, Oregon State University, Corvallis, OR, August 25, 2025.

Norfolk, Honey. "'AI can't write like that!': A Test of People's Ability to Differentiate Between AI and Human-Generated Text." *Arkansas Association of Sociology, Anthropology, and Criminology (AASAC)*, University of Arkansas – Little Rock, Little Rock, AR, November 8, 2024.

Norfolk, Honey. "'AI can't write like that!': A Test of People's Ability to Differentiate Between AI and Human-Generated Text." *University of Central Arkansas (UCA)*, Conway, AR, April 6, 2024.

GUEST LECTURERS AND INVITED TALKS

Invited Speaker, Arkansas Higher Education Committee Hearing: "The Future of AI." *March 18, 2026*

Arkansas State Capitol (Department of Higher Education Committee) **Little Rock, Arkansas**

- Invited to present to the Arkansas State Senate with five peers as a college representative on the future of AI, its impact on education, and policy recommendations for legislators.

Invited Speaker, Women's History Month — "Girls with Options" *March 3, 2026 | March 5, 2026*

Carl Stuart Middle School (G3 Organization: Growth, Generosity, and Goals) **Conway, Arkansas**

- Delivered an invited talk to 7th-grade students on career pathways, entrepreneurship, college preparation, and long-term planning, with an emphasis on encouraging female students.
- Engaged students through discussion and real-world examples to encourage goal setting, confidence, and awareness of diverse academic and professional options.

GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Arkansas Space Grant Consortium (ASGC), Student Intensive Training (SIT) Grant — 2026

Wrote and secured a $30,000 grant from the Arkansas Space Grant Consortium (ASGC) to lead the "Collaborative Human-Robot Interaction" Student Intensive Training (SIT) project.

Student Undergraduate Research Fellowship (SURF) Grant, Arkansas Department of Higher Education — 2025

Funded independent study: "The Machine Didn't Cheat: Students, Faculty, and the Human Problem."

Arkansas Student Leadership Forum – Sponsored Participant — 2025

Fully funded sponsorship covering registration, travel, and participation to represent the University of Central Arkansas at a statewide leadership and policy development program.

VOLUNTEERING EXPERIENCE

Volunteer, VEX Robotics Tournament

University of Central Arkansas Robotics Club **Conway, Arkansas**

January 18, 2024 (11 hours)| January 24th, 2025 (6 hours) | November 22, 2025 (11 hours)

- Assisted in hosting and organizing VEX Robotics Tournament, facilitating logistics and ensuring smooth competition.
- Supported participants and judges, helping to coordinate matches and maintain event schedules.

Volunteer, VEX Robotics Competition

Conway High School **Conway, Arkansas**

February 10, 2024 (9 hours) | November 17, 2024 (4 hours) | November 15, 2025 (10 hours)

- Managed the queuing table, ensuring timely coordination of teams for each match, maintaining the competition schedule, and reducing delays.
- Assisted with event setup and supported teams and officials, contributing to smooth tournament execution.

Volunteer, STEM Day (Robotics Section)

University of Central Arkansas **Conway, Arkansas**

May 8, 2023(5 hours) | May 7, 2024 (9 hours) | May 6, 2025(6 hours)

- Engaged with children during STEM Day, guiding them in operating soccer bots and introducing them to basic robotics concepts.
- Taught participants about the importance of robotics and STEM, cultivating curiosity and enthusiasm for science and technology.

- Collaborated with fellow volunteers to create an engaging and interactive environment, ensuring a positive experience for all participants.

PROFESSIONAL ASSOCIATIONS

Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE)

9/2024-Present

Founder & President, UCA Student Chapter

Alpha Kappa Delta (AKD)

7/2025-Present

Member, International Sociology Honor Society